



Googl to acquire Nest

Search giant Google is finally acquiring a home automations startup Nest Labs for \$3.2 billion <http://dgit.in/GoogleNestDeal>



Being cool with Android?

Do you own Android phone? Simply check out these cool things to do with it on Quora you may have not probably heard before. <http://dgit.in/androidtips>

Taking Guard

We take a look at the current security landscape and understand what the biggest names in the industry are doing

Kul Bhushan

readersletters@thinkdigit.com

We've seen Twitter, Microsoft, Apple and many others adopting the two-factor verification procedure to prevent hackers from capturing control of their users' credentials. The addition of two-step verification is certainly a welcome move, but will it be enough to deal with the ever-growing cyber threats? Unlikely, according to Security Software maker Trend Micro.

"Two-factor authentication is not a cure all – while it can improve IT security, it also introduces new attack vectors that have to be considered and made secure as well. Mobile was the "next big thing" a few years ago. What about today's "next big thing", the Internet of Everything? Attackers and cybercriminals always go where the money and the users are. In the absence of a "killer app" that will get most users to welcome it with open arms, the Internet of Everything is probably not going to see much in the way of threats – for now", says Dhanya Thakkar - MD, Trend Micro for India & SAARC.

Trend Micro also predicts that mobile banking will be the target of malware. "2013 played host to major mobile threats, a trend which is expected to continue in 2014. This year is all about mobile banking. Unfortunately, we can also expect mobile threats like man-



The tweet by the SEA using Skype's official handle

in-the-middle (MitM) attacks to increase in 2014. Android will remain the most dominant OS in the market. But this dominance will continue to be exploited, as we predict the volume of malicious and high-risk Android apps to reach 3 million by the end of 2014," adds Thakkar.

Thakkar added that businesses should look into multiple BYOD (Bring Your Own Device) solutions to prevent cyber attacks. He stated that enterprises should look at data security within multiple dimensions including internal firewalls, intrusion prevention systems, Wi-Fi security etc. He added that companies should re-look at their security architecture and rebuild it to fit BYOD needs.

Cybercriminals will increasingly use targeted-attack type methodologies such as Open Source research and highly customised spear phishing, along with multiple exploits. In the context of targeted attacks, we'll see more clickjacking and

watering hole attacks, new exploits of choice and attacks via mobile devices.

We'll see one major data breach incident a month. Attacks leveraging vulnerabilities in widely used but unsupported software like Java 6 and Windows XP will intensify.

Microsoft's Twitter News account hacked by Syrian Electronic Army

Recently, Microsoft's Twitter News account was hacked by the Syrian Electronic Army (SEA), the same group responsible for hacking Xbox and Skype's Twitter and Facebook accounts on New Year's Eve. The message on Twitter was the same as on New Year's Day: "Don't use Microsoft emails (hotmail,outlook), They are monitoring your accounts and selling it to the governments. More details soon. #SEA."

After Microsoft's Twitter News account hack, the "Official Microsoft Blog" was

also hacked. It displayed SEA messages and redirected to the hacking group's website for at least some users.

In response to the cyber attacks a Microsoft spokesperson stated, "Microsoft is aware of targeted cyber attacks that temporarily affected the Xbox Support and Microsoft News Twitter accounts. The accounts were quickly reset and we can confirm that no customer information was compromised."

India to set up cyber command service

Indian Army is gearing up to combat possible cyber threats with a tri-service cyber command. According to Army Chief General Bikram Singh, the Ministry of Defence already has a draft on the subject, which the cabinet committee on security, led by the prime minister, will take up for discussion in the near future.

The government officials reportedly acknowledge that India needs to have a strong cyber command, considering the cyber security infrastructure of the country is "weak".

"Cyber command would ensure both, offensive and defensive cyber security capabilities. Issues like cyber warfare, cyber terrorism and cyber espionage would be taken care of by a cyber command," a top defence ministry official is quoted as saying.

Lately, many a government website has been hacked. Recently, Defence Research and Development Organisation